12–14 第二篇

The Invention of Paper: A Gift from Ancient China

Paper is so common today that we hardly think about where it came from. Yet this simple material changed human history. Before paper, people wrote on bamboo, silk, or animal skins. These materials were either heavy, expensive, or hard to produce. Paper made writing cheaper, lighter, and more widely available. It is one of the greatest inventions of all time. [1]

Paper was first made in China around 2,000 years ago. Cai Lun, an official in the Han Dynasty, is often credited with improving the papermaking process. He used plant fibers such as tree bark, hemp, and rags. The fibers were mixed with water, pounded into a pulp, and then spread flat to dry. This method produced sheets of paper that were strong and smooth. The technique spread slowly across Asia and later to the rest of the world. [2]

Paper changed how people communicated and learned. Books became easier to make and carry. Ideas could spread faster across borders. Governments used paper for records and orders. Artists painted on paper. Over time, paper became essential to culture, education, and daily life. Its impact on civilization cannot be overstated. [3]

Today, we use paper in countless ways—from books and newspapers to packaging and tissues. Although digital technology has reduced paper use in some areas, paper remains important. Many people still prefer reading on paper. Recycling has also become common to reduce waste. The invention that began in ancient China continues to serve us. [4]

The story of paper reminds us that simple innovations can change the world. What started as a way to write more easily has shaped every part of modern life. [5]

选项

A. Paper solved the problems of earlier writing materials and made knowledge more accessible to people everywhere. B. The process developed in ancient China laid the foundation for papermaking as we know it today. C. In this way, paper became a driving force behind the spread of knowledge and culture. D. Even in the digital age, paper has not lost its place in human life. E. This ancient invention continues to influence how we live, learn, and communicate today. F. For example, parchment was another early writing material made from animal skins, used in Europe before paper arrived.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍纸张司空见惯、改变人类历史、此前用竹简丝绸兽皮、笨重昂贵难制、纸张使书写更便宜轻便普及、为最伟大发明之一，空后需总结纸张对书写材料的改进意义。A的"solved the problems of earlier writing materials and made knowledge more accessible to people everywhere"与前文对应。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说纸约两千年前始创于中国、蔡伦改进工艺、用树皮麻布等植物纤维、捣浆摊平晾干、产坚韧平滑纸张、工艺传向亚洲及世界，空后需总结古代工艺对后世的奠基作用。B的"The process developed in ancient China laid the foundation for papermaking as we know it today"与前文呼应。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说纸张改变交流与学习、书籍易制作携带、思想传播更快、政府用纸记录、艺术家在纸上创作、对文明影响巨大，空后需总结知识文化传播的推动力。C的"In this way, paper became a driving force behind the spread of knowledge and culture"与前文对应。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前说今日纸张用途无数、数字技术减少部分用纸、纸张仍重要、许多人仍偏好纸质阅读、回收减少浪费、古代发明继续服务人类，空后需总结数字时代纸张的地位。D的"Even in the digital age, paper has not lost its place in human life"与前文呼应。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前说纸张故事提醒简单创新可改变世界、从方便书写到塑造现代生活方方面面，空后需总结古今影响。E的"This ancient invention continues to influence how we live, learn, and communicate today"与前文对应。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, parchment was another early writing material...**：以For example开头，为早期书写材料案例（羊皮纸）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[1]易被误选因涉及书写材料，但该空需总结纸张解决此前材料问题，而非补充羊皮纸这一替代材料的细节。